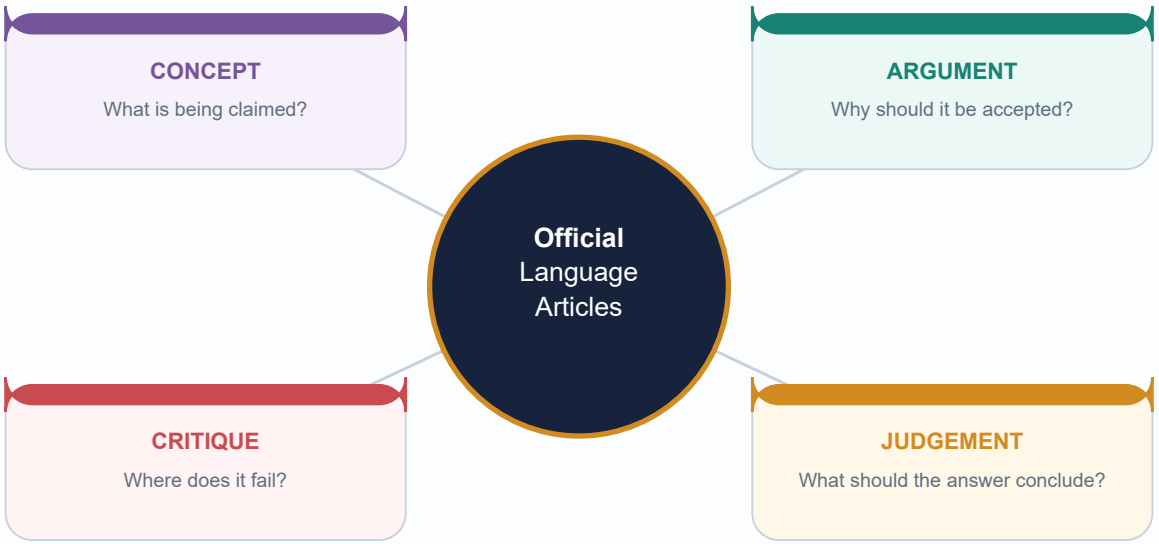
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: Official-Language.md + 40_Official-Language.md
Learning cards: 37



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-I / GS-II**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/40_Official-Language.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/40_Official-Language.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/40_Official-Language.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Official language of Union	**Hindi (Devanagari)** — **Art 343**
English	15 yrs (1950–65); continues **in addition to Hindi** under **Official Languages Act 1963, section 3**
Eighth Schedule	**22 languages** (originally **14**)
Linguistic Minorities Officer	**Art 350-B** (7th Amdt 1956)
National language	**NONE** (India has no national language)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hindi in Devanagari is the **official language of the Union** (Art 343) — but **not a "national language."** English was to end in **1965**, yet the **Official Languages Act 1963** continues it **in addition to Hindi** for specified purposes. States may choose their own official language (**not limited to the 8th Schedule**).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 Hindi in Devanagari is the official language of the Union (Art 343) — but not a "national language." English was to end in 1965, yet the Official Lang	**Dimension 2** □ No national language — only an official one. Big UPSC trap.
Dimension 3 □ 8th Schedule = 22 langs. Additions: Sindhi (1967) · Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992) ·	**Dimension 4** Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali (2003).

STATIC THEORY

- □ **No national language** — only an **official** one. Big UPSC trap.

- □ 8th Schedule = **22** langs. Additions: **Sindhi (1967)** · **Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992)** ·

- **Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali (2003)**.

- □ SC/HC and authoritative legislative texts ordinarily use **English**. Under Art

- 348(2), a Governor with the President's consent may authorise Hindi/another state official

- language in HC proceedings; **Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7** separately permits it in

MEMORY HOOK

No national language — only an official one. Big UPSC trap. | 8th Schedule = 22 langs. Additions: Sindhi (1967) · Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992) · | SC/HC and authoritative legislative texts ordinarily use English. Under Art

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

HC judgments/decrees/orders if accompanied by an authorised English translation.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 First Official Language Commission = **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by **G.B. Pant** committee.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 First Official Language Commission = B.G. Kher (1955); examined by G.B. Pant committee.	**Dimension 2** Committee of Parliament on Official Language = 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS), chaired by Home Minister.
Dimension 3 Art 351: Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a medium of expression	**Dimension 4** for all elements of India's composite culture.

STATIC THEORY

- Committee of Parliament on Official Language = **30 members (20 LS + 10 RS)**, chaired by **Home Minister**.

- **Art 351:** Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a **medium of expression

- for all elements of India's composite culture**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. First Official Language Commission = **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by **G.B. Pant** committee.

2. Committee of Parliament on Official Language = **30 members (20 LS + 10 RS)**, chaired by **Home Minister**.

3. Art 351: Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a **medium of expression

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Classical Language** status (a *separate scheme*, not the 8th Schedule): **Oct 2024** added **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali** → total **11**. **NEP three-language formula** row with **Tamil Nadu** over "Hindi imposition"; additional-language demands, which remain proposals unless constitutionally enacted.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Purpose: make this Core file independently able to answer directive-sensitive GS-I/GS-II questions on Part XVII, the official-vs-national-language scheme, the federal language controversy and the Eighth Schedule — with exact Articles — without opening Advanced. Distinguish Constitution text (Arts 343–351), statute (Official Languages Act 1963), executive scheme (classical languages) and policy (three-language formula) throughout.

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Constitutional language scheme	"official but no national language", "constitutional wisdom", Discuss	Art 343 → English continuance → federal accommodation → verdict
Federal language tension	"Hindi imposition", "three-language formula", Examine/Comment	Constitutional design → 1965 agitation → OLA 1967 → NEP row → balanced verdict
Eighth Schedule expansion	"should the 8th Schedule be expanded", Analyse	Function of the Schedule → amendment route → linguistic justice vs feasibility
Protection of linguistic minorities	"safeguards for linguistic minorities", Discuss	Arts 347, 350, 350A, 350B → Special Officer → implementation gap
Language of courts/laws	"English in the higher judiciary", Examine	Art 348 → Governor + OLA s.7 caveat → access-to-justice angle
Classical vs Eighth-Schedule status	Prelims-style distinction, Comment	Executive scheme vs constitutional Schedule → different purposes

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Constitution deliberately created an official *language without a* national *one: Hindi is the Union's official language (Art 343), but the scheme is built for accommodation, not imposition — which is why English survives and States choose their own tongues.*

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 The Constitution deliberately created an official language without a national one: Hindi is the Union's official language (Art 343), but the scheme is	**Dimension 2** India's language settlement is a negotiated federal compromise: the 1963 Act and its 1967 amendment converted a fifteen-year transition into an indefi
Dimension 3 The three-language formula is policy, not constitutional command, and education is a Concurrent-List subject, so the "Hindi imposition" dispute is a g	**Dimension 4** Eighth-Schedule membership is a matter of recognition and development, not everyday administration, so expanding it advances linguistic justice but al

STATIC THEORY

- India's language settlement is a negotiated federal compromise: the 1963 Act and its 1967 amendment converted a fifteen-year transition into an indefinite bilingualism because the 1965 anti-Hindi agitation showed that a hard switch was politically impossible.

- The three-language formula is policy, not constitutional command, and education is a Concurrent-List subject, so the "Hindi imposition" dispute is a genuine federal question rather than a settled constitutional one.

- Eighth-Schedule membership is a matter of recognition and development, not everyday administration, so expanding it advances linguistic justice but also raises administrative and equity costs that the amendment route must weigh.

- Classical-language status is an executive honour, not a constitutional category; conflating it with the Eighth Schedule is the commonest error in this topic.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → the constitutional scheme (Art 343 + English) → one federal qualification → verdict	3 units, at least two exact Articles
15	Thesis → Union language → State languages/minority safeguards → federal tension → qualified verdict	5–6 units incl. OLA 1963/1967
20	Thesis → Part XVII architecture → Union/State/courts → 8th Schedule → classical scheme & three-language policy → federal debate → graded verdict	6–8 units + a "text vs statute vs scheme vs policy" paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Language of the Union (Arts 343–344; the 1963/1967 statute)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Claim: Hindi is the Union's official language, with a numeral caveat. **Provision: Art 343(1)** — **Hindi in Devanagari** is the official language of the Union; the form of numerals is the **international form of Indian numerals**. **Mechanism:** it fixes the Union's default language of business. **Limitation:** "official language of the Union" is **not** "national language" — India has **none**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.4 BANK A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343–344; THE 1963/1967 STATUTE): RECALL MAP

5.4 Bank A — Language of the Union (Arts 343–344; the 1963/1967 statute)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: Hindi is the Union's official language, with a numeral caveat. Provision: Art 343(1) — Hindi in Devanagari is the official language of the Un	**Dimension 2** Claim: English was given a fifteen-year runway, extendable. Provision: Art 343(2) continued English for 15 years (1950–1965); Art 343(3) empowers Pa
Dimension 3 Claim: a statute, not the Constitution, made English permanent. Provision: the Official Languages Act, 1963 continues English in addition to Hindi f	**Dimension 4** Claim: review of Hindi's progress is institutionalised. Provision: Art 344(1) — the President constitutes a Language Commission at the fifth and ten

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** English was given a fifteen-year runway, extendable. **Provision: Art 343(2)** continued **English for 15 years (1950–1965)**; **Art 343(3)** empowers Parliament to provide by law for its continued use thereafter. **Mechanism:** it built in a transition rather than a cliff-edge. **Limitation:** the runway alone did not settle the politics — Parliament had to act.

- **Claim:** a statute, not the Constitution, made English permanent. **Provision:** the **Official Languages Act, 1963** continues English **in addition to Hindi** for specified purposes; substituted section 3, effective in 1968 after the **1967 amendment**, created a State-plus-Parliament discontinuance lock. It requires resolutions of *all States that have not adopted Hindi as official language* and then each House of Parliament; the Act does not use “associate official language”. **Mechanism:** it converted Art 343's transition into a durable **bilingual** regime. **Limitation:** this is **statute**, amendable by Parliament — distinguish it from the constitutional Articles.

- **Claim:** review of Hindi's progress is institutionalised. **Provision: Art 344(1)** — the **President constitutes a Language Commission** at the fifth and tenth year (first under **B.G. Kher, 1955**); **Art 344(2)** — a **Committee of Parliament (30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS)**, by convention chaired by the **Union Home Minister**, examines the recommendations (the Kher Commission was examined by the **G.B. Pant** committee). **Mechanism:** a periodic constitutional review of the switch to Hindi. **Limitation:** its recommendations are advisory, filtered through political feasibility.

- / **Claim:** Part XVII is a drafted compromise, which explains its hedged design. **Evidence:** the **Munshi–Ayyangar formula** (K.M. Munshi and N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar) was the Constituent Assembly **via media** between Hindi-protagonists (who wanted Hindi installed at once as the sole national language) and non-Hindi members — it produced **Hindi as official language, English continued for fifteen years, and no "national" language**. **Significance:** the scheme's caution (numerals caveat, English continuance, State-language freedom) is **deliberate accommodation**, not oversight. **Limitation:** "Munshi–Ayyangar formula" is a **descriptive label** for the compromise, not a constitutional term.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: Hindi is the Union's official language, with a numeral caveat. **Provision: Art 343(1)** — **Hindi in Devanagari** is the official language of the Union; the form of numerals is the **international form of Indian numerals**. **Mechanism:** it fixes the Union's default language of business. **Limitation:** "official language of the Union" is **not** "national language" — India has **none**.

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4. Claim: review of Hindi's progress is institutionalised. **Provision: Art 344(1)** — the **President constitutes a Language Commission** at the fifth and tenth year (first under **B.G. Kher, 1955**); **Art 344(2)** — a **Committee of Parliament (30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS)**, by convention chaired by the **Union Home Minister**, examines the recommendations (the Kher Commission was examined by the **G.B. Pant** committee). **Mechanism:** a periodic constitutional review of the switch to Hindi. **Limitation:** its recommendations are advisory, filtered through political feasibility.

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Language of the Union (Arts 343–344; the 1963/1967 statute)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — State official languages (Arts 345–347)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Art 345:** a **State legislature** may adopt **Hindi or any language(s) in use in the State** as its official language; until it does, **English** continues.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — STATE OFFICIAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345–347): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — State official languages (Arts 345–347)

V

Dimension 1 Art 345: a State legislature may adopt Hindi or any language(s) in use in the State as its official language; until it does, English continues.	**Dimension 2** Art 346: the language authorised for communication between States and between a State and the Union (Hindi or the authorised language).
Dimension 3 Art 347: on a demand by a substantial proportion of a State's population, the President may direct official recognition of that language in the Stat	**Dimension 4** Key point: a State's choice is not restricted to the Eighth Schedule — States have adopted non-Schedule languages. Limitation: recognition is at exe

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 346:** the language authorised for communication **between States** and **between a State and the Union** (Hindi or the authorised language).

- **Art 347:** on a demand by a substantial proportion of a State's population, the **President** may direct official recognition of that language in the State (a linguistic-minority safeguard).

- **Key point:** a State's choice is **not restricted to the Eighth Schedule** — States have adopted non-Schedule languages. **Limitation:** recognition is at executive/legislative discretion, so protection varies.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 345: a **State legislature** may adopt **Hindi or any language(s) in use in the State** as its official language; until it does, **English** continues.

2. Art 346: the language authorised for communication **between States** and **between a State and the Union** (Hindi or the authorised language).

3. Art 347: on a demand by a substantial proportion of a State's population, the **President** may direct official recognition of that language in the State (a linguistic-minority safeguard).

4. Key point: a State's choice is **not restricted to the Eighth Schedule** — States have adopted non-Schedule languages. **Limitation:** recognition is at executive/legislative discretion, so protection varies.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — State official languages (Arts 345–347)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — Language of courts and legislation (Arts 348–349; authoritative-text statutes)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Art 348(1): proceedings of the **Supreme Court and every High Court**, and the authoritative texts of **Bills, Acts, Ordinances, orders, rules and regulations**, are in **English** until Parliament provides otherwise.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.6 BANK C — LANGUAGE OF COURTS AND LEGISLATION (ARTS 348–349; AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT STATUTES): RECALL MAP

5.6 Bank C — Language of courts and legislation (Arts 348–349; authoritative-text statutes)

V

Dimension 1 Art 348(1): proceedings of the Supreme Court and every High Court, and the authoritative texts of Bills, Acts, Ordinances, orders, rules and regulat	**Dimension 2** Art 348(2): a Governor, with the President's prior consent, may authorise Hindi or the State's official language in High Court proceedings — but not
Dimension 3 Authoritative-text routes: Art 348(3) deems a Governor-authorised English	**Dimension 4** translation of specified State texts authoritative. Sections 5–6 of the Official Languages Act, 1963 govern authorised Hindi texts. The Authoritative

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 348(2):** a **Governor**, with the **President's prior consent**, may authorise **Hindi or the State's official language in High Court proceedings** — but **not** for its judgments, decrees or orders, which remain in English unless the **Official Languages Act, 1963 (s.7)** route is used with an **authorised English translation**.

- **Authoritative-text routes: Art 348(3)** deems a Governor-authorised English

- translation of specified State texts authoritative. Sections **5–6 of the Official Languages Act, 1963** govern authorised Hindi texts. The **Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act, 1973** separately enables authoritative Central-law translations in Eighth-Schedule languages other than Hindi through presidential authority and Gazette publication.

- **Art 349:** during the first fifteen years, certain language-related Bills required the **President's prior sanction** — a transitional safeguard. **Limitation:** the persistence of English in the higher judiciary is defended for national uniformity but criticised as an **access-to-justice** barrier.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 348(1): proceedings of the **Supreme Court and every High Court**, and the authoritative texts of **Bills, Acts, Ordinances, orders, rules and regulations**, are in **English** until Parliament provides otherwise.

2. Art 348(2): a **Governor**, with the **President's prior consent**, may authorise **Hindi or the State's official language in High Court proceedings** — but **not** for its judgments, decrees or orders, which remain in English unless the **Official Languages Act, 1963 (s.7)** route is used with an **authorised English translation**.

3. Authoritative-text routes: Art 348(3) deems a Governor-authorised English

4. Art 349: during the first fifteen years, certain language-related Bills required the **President's prior sanction** — a transitional safeguard. **Limitation:** the persistence of English in the higher judiciary is defended for national uniformity but criticised as an **access-to-justice** barrier.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — Language of courts and legislation (Arts 348–349; authoritative-text statutes)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Special safeguards and the directive on Hindi (Arts 350–351)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Art 350: right to submit a **representation for redress of grievances** in **any language** used in the Union or a State.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.7 BANK D — SPECIAL SAFEGUARDS AND THE DIRECTIVE ON HINDI (ARTS 350–351): RECALL MAP

5.7 Bank D — Special safeguards and the directive on Hindi (Arts 350–351)

V

Dimension 1 Art 350: right to submit a representation for redress of grievances in any language used in the Union or a State.	**Dimension 2** Art 350A (added by the 7th Amendment, 1956): facilities for instruction in the mother tongue at the primary stage for children of linguistic-minorit
Dimension 3 Art 350B (added by the 7th Amendment, 1956): a Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities, appointed by the President, to investigate and report on s	**Dimension 4** Art 351: a directive to the Union to develop the Hindi language so it may serve as a medium of expression for all elements of India's composite cult

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 350A** *(added by the **7th Amendment, 1956**)*: facilities for **instruction in the mother tongue at the primary stage** for children of linguistic-minority groups.

- **Art 350B** *(added by the **7th Amendment, 1956**)*: a **Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities**, appointed by the **President**, to investigate and report on safeguards (an investigative, non-enforcing office).

- **Art 351:** a **directive to the Union to develop the Hindi language** so it may serve as a **medium of expression for all elements of India's composite culture**, drawing on Hindustani, Sanskrit and the Eighth-Schedule languages. **Limitation:** it is a **directive within Part XVII** (not a Fundamental Right and not a Part IV DPSP), so it guides policy rather than conferring enforceable rights.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 350: right to submit a **representation for redress of grievances** in **any language** used in the Union or a State.

2. Art 350A *(added by the **7th Amendment, 1956**)*: facilities for **instruction in the mother tongue at the primary stage** for children of linguistic-minority groups.

3. Art 350B *(added by the **7th Amendment, 1956**)*: a **Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities**, appointed by the **President**, to investigate and report on safeguards (an investigative, non-enforcing office).

4. Art 351: a **directive to the Union to develop the Hindi language** so it may serve as a **medium of expression for all elements of India's composite culture**, drawing on Hindustani, Sanskrit and the Eighth-Schedule languages. **Limitation:** it is a **directive within Part XVII** (not a Fundamental Right and not a Part IV DPSP), so it guides policy rather than conferring enforceable rights.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Special safeguards and the directive on Hindi (Arts 350–351)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Bank E — The Eighth Schedule and how a language is added (routed to 2024 Prelims Q72)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Claim: the Eighth Schedule lists recognised languages, now **22** (originally **14**). **Function:** representation on the Language Commission and enrichment of Hindi (Art 351) — **not** a list of everyday administrative languages. **Mechanism:** membership signals recognition and development support.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** a language is added **only by constitutional amendment**. **Provision:** additions are made under **Art 368** — **Sindhi (21st Amendment, 1967)**; **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali (71st Amendment, 1992)**; **Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali (92nd Amendment, 2003)**. **Mechanism:** this is the exact answer to "how is a language added to the Eighth Schedule" — **not** an executive notification. **Limitation:** additional-language demands remain proposals, not enacted additions; do not freeze a changing demand count.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: the Eighth Schedule lists recognised languages, now **22** (originally **14**). **Function:** representation on the Language Commission and enrichment of Hindi (Art 351) — **not** a list of everyday administrative languages. **Mechanism:** membership signals recognition and development support.

2. Claim: a language is added **only by constitutional amendment**. **Provision:** additions are made under **Art 368** — **Sindhi (21st Amendment, 1967)**; **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali (71st Amendment, 1992)**; **Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali (92nd Amendment, 2003)**. **Mechanism:** this is the exact answer to "how is a language added to the Eighth Schedule" — **not** an executive notification. **Limitation:** additional-language demands remain proposals, not enacted additions; do not freeze a changing demand count.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Bank E — The Eighth Schedule and how a language is added (routed to 2024 Prelims Q72)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Bank F — Classical languages (executive scheme) and the three-language formula (policy)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

/ **Claim:** "classical language" is an **executive scheme**, not a constitutional category. **Evidence:** it is a **Government of India notification** with criteria set by the executive (via the Sahitya Akademi's linguistic-experts committee), conferring awards, chairs and funding — **unrelated to the Eighth Schedule**. **Status:** total **11** after **Oct 2024** added **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali** (earlier six: Tamil 2004, Sanskrit 2005, Kannada & Telugu 2008, Malayalam 2013, Odia 2014) — verify before quoting. **Limitation:** it carries **no constitutional status**; conflating it with the Schedule is the standard trap.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □/□□ **Claim:** the three-language formula is **policy, not constitutional command**. **Evidence:** it originates in the **Kothari Commission** and the **National Policy on Education (1968)**, reaffirmed by **NEP 2020**; **education is a Concurrent-List subject**, so States implement it. **Federal controversy (stated fairly):** *For* — multilingualism and national integration; *Against* — **Tamil Nadu** follows a two-language policy and reads the formula as **Hindi imposition** and an intrusion on State autonomy. **Verdict frame:** because it is policy on a Concurrent subject, the dispute is a **legitimate federal negotiation**, not a constitutional violation by either side.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. /□ **Claim:** "classical language" is an **executive scheme**, not a constitutional category. **Evidence:** it is a **Government of India notification** with criteria set by the executive (via the Sahitya Akademi's linguistic-experts committee), conferring awards, chairs and funding — **unrelated to the Eighth Schedule**. **Status:** □ total **11** after **Oct 2024** added **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali** (earlier six: Tamil 2004, Sanskrit 2005, Kannada & Telugu 2008, Malayalam 2013, Odia 2014) — verify before quoting. **Limitation:** it carries **no constitutional status**; conflating it with the Schedule is the standard trap.

2. /□□ **Claim:** the three-language formula is **policy, not constitutional command**. **Evidence:** it originates in the **Kothari Commission** and the **National Policy on Education (1968)**, reaffirmed by **NEP 2020**; **education is a Concurrent-List subject**, so States implement it. **Federal controversy (stated fairly):** *For* — multilingualism and national integration; *Against* — **Tamil Nadu** follows a two-language policy and reads the formula as **Hindi imposition** and an intrusion on State autonomy. **Verdict frame:** because it is policy on a Concurrent subject, the dispute is a **legitimate federal negotiation**, not a constitutional violation by either side.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Bank F — Classical languages (executive scheme) and the three-language formula (policy)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Why the scheme accommodates:** the framers faced a multilingual polity where imposing one language risked secession-level resentment; the compromise (official Hindi + continued English + State languages) traded symbolic uniformity for political unity.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.10 MECHANISM, INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

5.10 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ Why the scheme accommodates: the framers faced a multilingual polity where imposing one language risked secession-level resentment; the compromise	**Dimension 2** □□ Why English persisted: the 1965 agitation demonstrated that non-Hindi States would resist a hard switch, so the 1967 amendment made continuance dep
Dimension 3 □□ Consequences: flexibility preserved unity but left recurrent friction (three-language formula, Schedule-expansion demands, English in courts) as th	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Why English persisted:** the **1965** agitation demonstrated that non-Hindi States would resist a hard switch, so the **1967** amendment made continuance depend on their consent — entrenching bilingualism.

- □□ **Consequences:** flexibility preserved unity but left recurrent friction (three-language formula, Schedule-expansion demands, English in courts) as the ordinary politics of a plurilingual federation.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Mechanism, incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elite/access critique: □□ the persistence of **English** in higher administration and the judiciary advantages the English-educated and can impede access to justice for non-English speakers.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.11 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT AND REGIONAL VARIATION: RECALL MAP

5.11 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

V

Dimension 1 Elite/access critique: □□ the persistence of English in higher administration and the judiciary advantages the English-educated and can impede access	**Dimension 2** Imposition critique and counter: □□ Hindi-promotion (Art 351, three-language formula) is read in the South as imposition; the counter is that Art 343'
Dimension 3 Schedule-expansion debate: □□ expansion advances linguistic justice but raises administrative and recruitment-examination burdens and equity questions	**Dimension 4** Regional variation: □□ Hindi-belt States, the North-East and the South relate to the scheme very differently — language politics is region-specific, n

STATIC THEORY

- **Imposition critique and counter:** □□ Hindi-promotion (Art 351, three-language formula) is read in the South as **imposition**; the counter is that Art 343's numerals caveat, English's continuance and the State-language freedom were all built to prevent exactly that.

- **Schedule-expansion debate:** □□ expansion advances **linguistic justice** but raises administrative and recruitment-examination burdens and equity questions among unrecognised languages.

- **Regional variation:** □□ Hindi-belt States, the North-East and the South relate to the scheme very differently — language politics is **region-specific**, not uniform.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

HIGH

Foundation · 5.12 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Scheme verdict: "India chose an official language without a national one precisely to hold a plurilingual federation together; the absence of a national language is the design, not a defect."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.12 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.12 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Scheme verdict: "India chose an official language without a national one precisely to hold a plurilingual federation together; the absence of a nation	**Dimension 2** Federal verdict: "The three-language formula is policy on a Concurrent subject, so the Hindi-imposition dispute is best resolved by negotiation and ch
Dimension 3 Schedule verdict: "Eighth-Schedule expansion is a question of recognition and development to be weighed by amendment, not an administrative convenienc	**Dimension 4** Classical-language verdict: "Classical status is an executive honour resting on antiquity and an independent literary tradition, not a constitutional

STATIC THEORY

- **Federal verdict:** "The three-language formula is policy on a Concurrent subject, so the Hindi-imposition dispute is best resolved by negotiation and choice, not by treating either side as unconstitutional."

- **Schedule verdict:** "Eighth-Schedule expansion is a question of recognition and development to be weighed by amendment, not an administrative convenience — linguistic justice balanced against feasibility."

- **Classical-language verdict:** "Classical status is an executive honour resting on antiquity and an independent literary tradition, not a constitutional rank — it confers prestige and funding, not the legal standing of an Eighth-Schedule language."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.12 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.13 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
National vs official language	India has **no national language**; **Hindi (Devanagari)** is the **official language of the Union** (Art 343)
Adding a language to the 8th Schedule	By **constitutional amendment (Art 368)** — e.g. 21st (1967), 71st (1992), 92nd (2003); **not** an executive order
8th Schedule count	**22** (originally **14**)
Eighth Schedule vs classical language	Schedule = **constitutional** recognition; classical = a **separate executive scheme**
State official language	May be **any language in use** — **not restricted** to the 8th Schedule
English continuance	By the **Official Languages Act, 1963** (statute), made durable in **1967** — not by the Constitution alone
Art 350B	**Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities**, added by the **7th Amendment (1956)**
HC judgments in Hindi	**Proceedings** may be authorised (Art 348(2)); **judgments/orders** need an **English translation** (OLA 1963 s.7)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.13 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.13 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Numerals under Art 343	**International (Indian) form**, not Devanagari numerals
Three-language formula	**Policy** (NPE 1968/NEP 2020), **not** a constitutional command
Classical-language criteria	Executive-notified: **high antiquity (recorded history/texts of 1500–2000 years)**, a body of **ancient literature regarded as heritage**, an **original literary tradition not borrowed**, and a classical form **distinct from the modern** language
Who grants classical status	The **Union Government (Culture Ministry)** on the Linguistic Experts Committee's advice — **not** Parliament, **not** the Constitution
Art 344 vs Art 351	**344** = Official Language **Commission/Committee** machinery; **351** = the **directive to develop and spread Hindi**
Art 350A vs Art 350B	**350A** = **primary education** in the mother tongue for linguistic minorities; **350B** = the **Special Officer** for Linguistic Minorities

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.13 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.14 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 Hindi = official language of the Union (Art 343); India has no national language. Never state otherwise. **Eighth-Schedule additions are by constitutional amendment**; do not attribute them to an executive notification. Distinguish the **layers**: Constitution (Arts 343–351) · statute (Official Languages Act 1963/1967; Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act 1973) · executive scheme (classical languages) · policy (three-language formula).

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Classical-language totals change — cite **11 (Oct 2024)** with a re-verification note; do not quote the count as permanent.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.14 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.14 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 Classical-language totals change — cite 11 (Oct 2024) with a re-verification note; do not quote the count as permanent.	**Dimension 2** Art 350A and 350B were both added by the 7th Amendment (1956); 350B is an investigative office, not an enforcing one.
Dimension 3 Do not state a fixed number of pending Eighth-Schedule demands as settled — a changing demand count is not enacted law.	**Dimension 4** In courts, proceedings (not judgments) may be in Hindi under Art 348(2); judgments/orders require an authorised English translation.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Art 350A and 350B** were both added by the **7th Amendment (1956)**; 350B is an **investigative** office, not an enforcing one.

- □□ Do **not** state a fixed number of pending Eighth-Schedule demands as settled — a changing demand count is not enacted law.

- □ In courts, **proceedings** (not judgments) may be in Hindi under Art 348(2); judgments/orders require an authorised **English translation**.

- □ **Classical status ≠ Eighth-Schedule status:** classical recognition is a **Culture-Ministry executive scheme** (prestige/funding on criteria of antiquity and an independent literary tradition); Eighth-Schedule inclusion is **constitutional**, added by **Art 368 amendment** — never conflate the two.

- □ The **15-year window in Art 343(2)** (the Hindi-only transition) **expired in 1965**; English's continuance since rests on the **Official Languages Act, 1963 (amended 1967)** — a **statute**, not on Art 343 itself. Do not say the Constitution itself guarantees English.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 350A and 350B were both added by the **7th Amendment (1956)**; 350B is an **investigative** office, not an enforcing one.

2. In courts, **proceedings** (not judgments) may be in Hindi under Art 348(2); judgments/orders require an authorised **English translation**.

3. Classical status ≠ Eighth-Schedule status: classical recognition is a **Culture-Ministry executive scheme** (prestige/funding on criteria of antiquity and an independent literary tradition); Eighth-Schedule inclusion is **constitutional**, added by **Art 368 amendment** — never conflate the two.

4. The **15-year window in Art 343(2)** (the Hindi-only transition) **expired in 1965**; English's continuance since rests on the **Official Languages Act, 1963 (amended 1967)** — a **statute**, not on Art 343 itself. Do not say the Constitution itself guarantees English.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.14 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	72	Constitution amendment adding a language to the Eighth Schedule	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.* ***Years represented:*** *2024* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Constitution amendment adding a language to the Eighth Schedule

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 Constitution amendment adding a language to the Eighth Schedule	**Dimension 2** This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶	

STATIC THEORY

- This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Constitutional status: *Part XVII contains Articles 343-351. Article 343 makes Hindi in Devanagari script the official language of the Union and uses the international form of Indian numerals. The Constitution does not declare any national language.* ***Union settlement:*** *Article 343(2)'s initial fifteen-year continuation of English was followed by Parliament's Official Languages Act, 1963. Section 3, substituted in 1967, permits English to continue in addition to Hindi and protects Union communication with non-Hindi States through its provisos and section 3(5) consent lock.* ***Commission/committee distinction:*** *Article 344 provides the constitutional Commission and parliamentary committee sequence. The continuing Committee of Parliament on Official Language is the thirty-member statutory committee under section 4 of the 1963 Act, not a permanent Article 344 Commission.* ***Current institutional snapshot, checked 5 September 2026:*** *the official Committee portal identifies Union Home Minister Amit Shah as Chairperson and displays the thirteenth part of its report. Recommendations or Presidential directions cannot override section 3.* ***State variation:*** *Article 345 permits a State legislature to adopt one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi. Articles 346-347 govern intergovernmental communication and recognition of a language spoken by a substantial section. No single State-language template can be universalised.* ***Courts and authoritative texts:*** *Article 348 retains English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings and authoritative legal texts until valid legal change. Article 348(2) and section 7 allow bounded High Court use of Hindi/a State official language with prior Presidential consent and an authoritative English translation of judgments, decrees and orders.* ***Citizen/minority/development provisions:*** *Article 350 protects grievance representation in any language used in the Union or State; Articles 350A and 350B concern primary-stage mother-tongue facilities and the Special Officer for linguistic minorities; Article 351 directs development of Hindi while drawing on India's composite culture.* ***Rules:*** *the Official Languages (Use for Official Purposes of the Union) Rules, 1976 are displayed by the Department as amended in 1987, 2007 and They divide administration into Regions A/B/C and expressly exclude Tamil Nadu from their territorial extent. Rules do not amend Part XVII.* ***Separate categories:*** *the Eighth Schedule contains twenty-two languages. Scheduled status does not itself make a language official everywhere. Classical-language status and the three-language formula are separate executive/education-policy categories; October 2024 recognition brought the then official classical-language count to eleven.* ***Case/PYQ firewall:*** *Gujarat University, D.A.V. College and Associated Management control competence, minority safeguards and educational choice; none declares a national language. The routed 2024 Prelims constitutional- amendment demand is retained; current proposals are not treated as enacted.*

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE →
Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-I / GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-I / GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 65 (Part XVII; direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official update.
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official-source update.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Official-Language.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 65 (Part XVII; direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official update.

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official-source update.

- *Companion: basic/Official-Language.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = official-source update.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□ · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script** = **official language of the Union**; numerals = the **international form of Indian numerals**, not the Devanagari form.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343–344) □□: RECALL MAP

PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□

V

Dimension 1 □ Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union; numerals = the international form of Indian numerals, not the Devanagari form.	**Dimension 2** □ English to continue for 15 years (1950–1965); Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
Dimension 3 □ Language Commissions (5th & 10th year): first under B.G. Kher (1955); examined by a parliamentary	**Dimension 4** committee under G.B. Pant (1957).

STATIC THEORY

- □ **English** to continue for **15 years (1950–1965)**; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.

- □ **Language Commissions** (5th & 10th year): first under **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by a parliamentary

- committee under **G.B. Pant (1957)**.

- □ **Official Languages Act, 1963** — continues English **in addition to Hindi** for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business;

- substituted section 3, effective in 1968 after the 1967 amendment, requires English in specified communications and creates a State-plus-Parliament discontinuance lock.

- □ **Key trap:** Hindi is the **official** language — **NOT the "national language."** India has **no national

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = **official language of the Union**; numerals = the **international form of Indian numerals**, not the Devanagari form.

2. English to continue for **15 years (1950–1965)**; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.

3. Language Commissions (5th & 10th year): first under **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by a parliamentary

4. Official Languages Act, 1963 — continues English **in addition to Hindi** for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business;

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□ · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

language** (constitutionally).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Constitution does **not** specify states' official languages — a **state legislature** may adopt any language(s)

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345–347) □: RECALL MAP

PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) □

V

Dimension 1 □ Constitution does not specify states' official languages — a state legislature may adopt any language(s)	**Dimension 2** in use OR Hindi; until then, English continues.
Dimension 3 □ □ A state's choice is NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).	**Dimension 4** □ Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the President may direct official recognition of

STATIC THEORY

- in use OR Hindi; until then, **English** continues.

- □ □ A state's choice is **NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule** (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).

- □ **Art 347:** On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the **President** may direct official recognition of

- a language in a state (protects linguistic minorities).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Constitution does **not** specify states' official languages — a **state legislature** may adopt any language(s)

2. □ A state's choice is **NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule** (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).

3. Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the **President** may direct official recognition of

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349) □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **SC & HC proceedings** and **authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances** → **English only** (until

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (ARTS 348–349) □: RECALL MAP

PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349) □

V

Dimension 1 □ SC & HC proceedings and authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances → English only (until	**Dimension 2** Parliament provides otherwise).
Dimension 3 □ A Governor, with the President's prior consent, may authorise Hindi/another	**Dimension 4** state official language in High Court proceedings under Art 348(2). Separately, Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7 permits it in HC judgments/decrees/or

STATIC THEORY

- Parliament provides otherwise).

- □ A **Governor**, with the **President's prior consent**, may authorise Hindi/another

- state official language in **High Court proceedings** under Art 348(2). Separately, **Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7** permits it in HC judgments/decrees/orders if an authorised English translation accompanies them.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. SC & HC proceedings and **authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances** → **English only** (until

2. A **Governor**, with the **President's prior consent**, may authorise Hindi/another

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351) □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Art 350:** right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (ARTS 350–351) : RECALL MAP

PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351)

V

Dimension 1 Art 350: right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.	**Dimension 2** Art 350-A: mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.
Dimension 3 Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities (added by 7th	**Dimension 4** Amendment, 1956); headquarters moved from Allahabad to New Delhi on 1 June 2015.

STATIC THEORY

- **Art 350-A:** mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.

- **Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities** (added by **7th

- Amendment, 1956**); headquarters moved from Allahabad to** New Delhi on 1 June 2015**.

- **Art 351:** duty of the **Union to develop Hindi** so it may serve as a medium

- of expression for all elements of India's composite culture (enriched from Hindustani/Sanskrit/Eighth-Schedule languages).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Art 350:** right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.

2. **Art 350-A:** mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.

3. **Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities** (added by **7th

4. **Art 351:** duty of the **Union to develop Hindi** so it may serve as a medium

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351)

HIGH

Advanced · PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Currently **22 languages** (originally **14**).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE □□: RECALL MAP

PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE □□

V

Dimension 1 □ Currently 22 languages (originally 14).	**Dimension 2** □ Additions: Sindhi (21st Amdt, 1967); Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali (71st Amdt, 1992); Bodo, Dogri,
Dimension 3 Maithili, Santhali (92nd Amdt, 2003).	**Dimension 4** □ Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

STATIC THEORY

- □ Additions: **Sindhi** (21st Amdt, **1967**); **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali** (71st Amdt, **1992**); **Bodo, Dogri,

- Maithili, Santhali **(92nd Amdt,** 2003**).

- □ Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Currently **22 languages** (originally **14**).

2. Additions: **Sindhi** (21st Amdt, **1967**); **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali** (71st Amdt, **1992**); **Bodo, Dogri,

3. Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE □□

HIGH

Advanced · Committee of Parliament on Official Language □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Set up under the 1963 Act (constituted **1976**); **30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS**; by convention **chaired by the Union Home Minister**; reviews the progress of Hindi and reports to the **President**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Set up under the 1963 Act (constituted **1976**); **30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS**; by convention **chaired by the Union Home Minister**; reviews the progress of Hindi and reports to the **President**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Committee of Parliament on Official Language □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Hindi is the "national language"

CORRECT: it is the **official language of the Union**; **India has no national language**.

WRONG: The Eighth Schedule has 18 languages

CORRECT: 22 (originally 14).

WRONG: States must pick an official language from the Eighth Schedule

CORRECT: not restricted to it.

WRONG: English use ended in 1965

CORRECT: Official Languages Act 1963, section 3 continues it subject to its exact statutory safeguards.

WRONG: Classical-language status is under the Eighth Schedule

CORRECT: it is a **separate government scheme**, unrelated to the 8th Schedule.

WRONG: Article 348(2) alone authorises non-English HC judgments

CORRECT: it covers proceedings but excludes judgments, decrees and orders; **section 7 of the 1963 Act** supplies a separate route with an authorised English translation.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks (official-source verified)

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Classical Language** status (a **separate scheme**, not the 8th Schedule): **Oct 2024** — **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese & Bengali** added, taking the total to **11** (earlier 6: Tamil-2004, Sanskrit-2005, Kannada & Telugu-2008, Malayalam-2013, Odia-2014). □ **NEP 2020 "three-language formula"** row — **Tamil Nadu's** opposition to alleged **Hindi imposition**;

INTRO & ORIGIN

federal-language politics.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ Additional-language demands remain proposals unless enacted through constitutional amendment; do not freeze a disputed demand count as settled law.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks (official-source verified)

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE
"India has an official language but no national language." Discuss the constitutional wisdom of this scheme. The three-language formula and the federal tension over Hindi imposition. Should the Eighth Schedule be expanded? Weigh linguistic justice against administrative feasibility.

STUDY LINK
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI